

Subin C S

Director of Design, 14+ Years

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PROFESSIONAL SUMMARY

A results-driven Design Leader with 14+ years of experience driving design strategy, organization-wide transformation, and experience innovation across fast-scaling tech environments. I lead with clarity, empathy, and strategic rigor, balancing creative excellence with measurable business outcomes.

believe that “talent is not enough”; creativity must be supported by structure, business understanding, and human-centered processes. My focus is on building design-led organizations, nurturing high-performing teams, and aligning design outcomes with business goals and data-backed insights

PORTFOLIO & LINKS

Linkedin:

<https://www.linkedin.com/in/subin-sundaresan/>

Medium:

<https://medium.com/@subintheuxdesigner>

Dribbble:

<https://dribbble.com/subincs>

Portfolio:

[Visit my portfolio](#)

CORE STRENGTHS

Design Strategy & Leadership • DesignOps & Systems Thinking • Experience Innovation • Data-Informed Design • AI & Automation • Design Culture & Mentorship • Brand Evolution • Stakeholder Alignment • Product & Business Strategy • Design System • AI Driven Products

EXPERIENCE

AI Design Consultant • Independent / Freelance

Oct 2025 - Present

Driving AI adoption across design and product organizations by embedding tools such as Claude, Midjourney, Windsurf, Figma AI, and Cursor into everyday workflows, reducing the design-to-development cycle by up to 40%. Partnering with CPOs, CTOs, and design leaders to define scalable AI strategies, enabling teams to transition from isolated experimentation to organization-wide AI adoption.

Coaching designers and design leaders on prompt engineering, AI-assisted design workflows, leadership development, and AI-first ways of working and helping teams build high-performing, future-ready design organizations that leverage AI to accelerate innovation while maintaining quality, consistency, and human-centered design principles.

Director of Design @ Yubi (formerly CredAvenue)

Jun 2022 - Sep 2025

Led design transformation across 13 products including Yubi, Aspero, YuCollect, Spocto, and Accumn, building a scalable and cohesive experience ecosystem supporting a \$140M+ fintech platform.

Executive Partnership: Worked closely with the CEO, CPO, CTO, and business leaders to shape long-term product and design strategy, aligning customer trust, scalability, and innovation with business outcomes.

Strategic Stakeholder Collaboration: Partnered with C-suite leaders, investors, and global teams to connect design decisions with revenue growth, go-to-market priorities, and platform expansion.

Design & People Leadership: Built, managed, and mentored a 20+ member design organization spanning Associate Design Directors, Design Leads, Product Designers, UX Researchers, and Motion Designers, growing leadership capability and design maturity across teams.

DesignOps & Governance: Established organization-wide DesignOps practices including OKR-driven planning, design rituals, quality reviews, and governance models to ensure consistency, speed, and operational excellence.

Y.Design System & AI Enablement: Conceived and led Y.Design, a fully token-based, multi-brand design system powered by AI-assisted workflows and enabled Figma-to-UI acceleration using Phoenix Codie and Figma MCP, significantly improving design-to-development velocity and consistency.

Operational & Financial Impact: Reduced design and development overhead by 45%, contributing to an operational cost reduction of ₹186 Cr in FY25 and ₹72 Cr in FY24 through system-led standardization and multi-brand scalability.

Culture & Craft Leadership: Built a high-performance, psychologically safe design culture grounded in ownership, empathy, and craft excellence, elevating design from execution to strategic influence across the organization.

Vision & Innovation: Championed a data-informed, system-driven design vision, ensuring every Yubi experience reflects clarity, trust, and simplicity while supporting long-term platform growth.

Lead Designer @ Khatabook

Feb 2021 - May 2022

SME fintech platform, 10M+ registered businesses, Series C, \$100M raised. Spearheaded Khatabook's evolution from a single-product bookkeeping app into a multi-product Super App serving millions of MSMEs across India.

Super App transformation: Architected the unified experience framework connecting bookkeeping, invoicing, payments, and lending, the foundational product strategy that defined Khatabook's next growth phase.

Khatabook Loans (0-to-1): Designed and launched the end-to-end credit product from discovery to GA, expanding financial access for 2M+ merchants within 6 months of launch.

Design system: Built a modular, scalable design system from scratch, improving delivery velocity and enabling a small team to ship consistently across 4 product domains.

Data-informed UX: Used analytics and user research to identify and fix drop-off in the onboarding funnel, improving activation rate by ~22% across new merchant cohorts.

Inclusive design: Championed localised, accessible UX for India's linguistically diverse audience, supporting 8 regional languages and WCAG AA compliance across core flows.

Lead Product Designer @ Solv (Standard Chartered)

Sep 2019 - Feb 2021

B2B trade & credit platform for SMEs backed by Standard Chartered Bank. Owned end-to-end UX for Solv's core trade and working capital product, working within a globally distributed team.

Global distributed team: Shipped features simultaneously across iOS, Android, and web with geographically distributed teams across Singapore, India, and Africa, managing cross-timezone design delivery

Complex enterprise UX: Designed buyer-supplier trade flows, credit application journeys, and regulated KYC onboarding for SMEs in high-stakes financial environments

Design system: Established Solv's first shared component library aligned with Standard Chartered's enterprise design standards

Data-driven UX: Collaborated with analytics teams to translate behavioural insights into design decisions that improved engagement and conversion

Head of Design @ Hashedin by Deloitte

May 2015 - May 2019

Built Hashedin's design function from 1 to 32 designers, establishing the 'Hashedin User Experience (HUX)' practice as a standalone revenue-generating vertical serving 20+ enterprise clients across the US, UK, and India.

Practice from scratch: Founded HUX, defining the vision, operating model, hiring strategy, design standards, delivery frameworks, and client engagement methodology that established UX as a core business capability.

Team growth & leadership: Hired, mentored, and scaled multidisciplinary teams across product design, visual design, UX research, and service design, fostering a high-performance culture focused on collaboration and continuous learning.

DesignOps & process maturity: Introduced design reviews, design critiques, research operations, design quality frameworks, estimation models, and standardized delivery processes that improved consistency and execution across multiple client engagements.

Client & stakeholder management: Partnered with founders, product leaders, engineering managers, and executive stakeholders to align design strategy with business goals, influence product roadmaps, and drive customer-centric decision-making.

Enterprise product strategy: Led discovery workshops, design sprints, and product strategy engagements across enterprise SaaS, healthcare, logistics, fintech, and edtech, helping clients define scalable product visions and user experience strategies.

Research-driven design: Established user research practices including customer interviews, usability testing, journey mapping, and synthesis workshops to inform product decisions and reduce delivery risk.

International client portfolio: Delivered design strategy and execution for more than 20 enterprise products across the US, UK, and India, with several startups successfully progressing through Series A and Series B funding after product launches.

Studio leadership: Directed multiple concurrent client engagements, balancing delivery, resource planning, stakeholder communication, quality assurance, and business priorities across cross-functional teams.

Business development: Supported pre-sales activities by leading discovery sessions, shaping product vision, creating proposals, and presenting design strategies that contributed to winning new enterprise engagements.

Rapid career progression: Joined as Design Lead and was promoted to Head of Design within 12 months in recognition of leadership, delivery excellence, and organizational impact.

Senior Product Designer @ Echidna	<i>Apr 2014 - Mar 2015</i>
Product Designer @ Brainistic Technologies	<i>Jan 2013 - Mar 2014</i>
UI/UX designer@ Institex Trading Pvt Ltd	<i>Feb 2011 - Dec 2011</i>
Web Developer and Designer @ NIC	<i>Nov 2010 - Feb 2011</i>

EDUCATION AND CERTIFICATIONS

Bachelor of Computer Engineering, GPTC / University of Kerala · 2007–2010

Web & Graphic Design, ICAT School of Design · 2010–2011

Human Computer Interaction (HCI), Interaction Design Foundation (IxDF) · 2015